EXISTENTIALISM

EXISTENTIALISM AS A FAMILY → KIERKEGAARD: INDIVIDUAL, SUBJECTIVITY, SPHERES → HEIDEGGER: DASEIN, BEING-IN-THE-WORLD, EQUIPMENT → HEIDEGGER: THE THEY, ANXIETY → HEIDEGGER: TEMPORALITY, FUTURE PRIORITY → SARTRE: EXISTENCE, IN-ITSELF, FOR-ITSELF

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◉ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 — EXISTENTIALISM AS A FAMILY: COMMON PROBLEM, DISTINCT PROJECTS

FAMILY, NOT ONE SCHOOL · LIVED AND SITUATED EXISTENCE · FAITH / ONTOLOGY / FREEDOM · NOT NIHILISM OR SELF-HELP · EXACT ATTRIBUTION

START → concrete lived existence resists reduction to abstract system or fixed nature.

EXISTING INDIVIDUAL → situated, finite, choosing and self-interpreting existence. → **KIERKEGAARD → Christian inwardness, anti-Hegelian individual and self before God.** → **HEIDEGGER → fundamental ontology through Dasein and finite being-in-the-world.**

COMMON ORIENTATION

- Concrete existence is lived, finite, situated and self-interpreting.
- Abstract systems and fixed natures can conceal the person who must choose.
- Individuality, anxiety, responsibility and authenticity recur across the family.

THREE DISTINCT PROJECTS

- Kierkegaard: religious inward commitment and selfhood before God.
- Heidegger: fundamental ontology through finite being-in-the-world.
- Sartre: atheistic consciousness, nothingness and situated freedom.

EXAMINER'S FILTER

- Do not universalise Sartre's slogan across all existentialists.
- Do not confuse anxiety with clinical fear or authenticity with nonconformity.
- Treat existentialism as a problem-field and preserve thinker-specific grounds.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Abstract system or fixed nature -> loss of the concrete individual -> return to lived existence -> three distinct projects of faith, ontology and freedom.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Existentialism is best treated as a family of projects united by the priority of lived, situated existence but divided over whether the self is grounded before God, disclosed through Being, or made through atheistic freedom.

01

STAGE 01 — KIERKEGAARD: INDIVIDUAL, SUBJECTIVITY, SPHERES, ANXIETY, DESPAIR AND FAITH

EXISTING INDIVIDUAL · SUBJECTIVITY != WHIM · SPHERES + ANXIETY + DESPAIR · LEAP / FAITH / ABRAHAM · RESPONSIBLE SELFHOOD

SYSTEM → universal mediation loses the particular person who must exist and choose.

EXISTING INDIVIDUAL → temporal, passionate, responsible and irreducibly singular. → **TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY → existential appropriation; NOT whatever I feel is true.** → **SPHERES → aesthetic immediacy; ethical duty; religious selfhood before God.**

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SYSTEM → universal mediation loses the particular person who must exist and choose.
- EXISTING INDIVIDUAL → temporal, passionate, responsible and irreducibly singular.
- TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY → existential appropriation; NOT whatever I feel is true.
- SPHERES → aesthetic immediacy; ethical duty; religious selfhood before God.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- SPHERES → qualitative orientations crossed by decision, not automatic age-phases.
- POSSIBILITY → anxiety / dread → dizziness of freedom → choice → becoming a self.
- DESPAIR → not willing to be oneself OR defiantly willing without one's ground.
- LEAP / FAITH → lived God-relation; not mere caprice or evidence-free opinion.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ABRAHAM → teleological suspension clarifies faith and creates an ethical problem.
- VERDICT → responsible inwardness is powerful; public criteria remain incomplete.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — System vs individual -> existential appropriation -> qualitative spheres -> possibility and anxiety -> choice -> despair or faith -> responsible selfhood.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: For Kierkegaard, becoming a self requires the single individual to appropriate existential truth through responsible choice: anxiety discloses freedom, despair exposes misrelation, and faith claims to re-ground the self before God.

02

STAGE 02 — HEIDEGGER: DASEIN, BEING-IN-THE-WORLD, EQUIPMENT AND CARE

FUNDAMENTAL ONTOLOGY · UNITARY BEING-IN-THE-WORLD · READY / PRESENT AT HAND · CARE: THROWN PROJECTION · THEORY IS DERIVATIVE

PROJECT → fundamental ontology; Heidegger resists Sartrean humanistic existentialism. → **DASEIN → the being for whom Being is an issue; not mind or biological object.** → **BEING-IN-THE-WORLD → unitary structure; not subject inside a container-world.** → **WORLDHOOD → meaningful referential context of concern, projects and being-with.** → **READY-TO-HAND → absorbed equipment; breakdown reveals the in-order-to nexus.**

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PROJECT → fundamental ontology; Heidegger resists Sartrean humanistic existentialism.
- DASEIN → the being for whom Being is an issue; not mind or biological object.
- BEING-IN-THE-WORLD → unitary structure; not subject inside a container-world.
- WORLDHOOD → meaningful referential context of concern, projects and being-with.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- READY-TO-HAND → absorbed equipment; breakdown reveals the in-order-to nexus.
- PRESENT-AT-HAND → detached object of theory; derivative from practical involvement.
- CARE → ahead-of-itself + already-in a world + alongside entities.
- THROWNESS → unchosen given; PROJECTION → possibilities; FALLENNESS → absorption.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DAS MAN → ordinary public intelligibility; inauthenticity is not simple moral evil.
- BRIDGE → anxiety interrupts familiar significance and discloses finite possibility.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Question of Being -> Dasein -> being-in-the-world -> ready-to-hand nexus -> breakdown -> present-at-hand -> care as thrown projection and everyday absorption.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Heidegger replaces the detached subject with Dasein's unitary being-in-the-world, whose equipmental involvement and threefold care disclose thrown, projected and everyday existence before theoretical representation.

03

STAGE 03 — HEIDEGGER: THE THEY, ANXIETY, DEATH, RESOLUTENESS AND AUTHENTICITY

ANXIETY DISCLOSES FINITUDE · DEATH: OWN / CERTAIN / INDEFINITE · ANTICIPATORY RESOLUTENESS · AUTHENTIC != ISOLATED HERO · FINITE ECSTATIC TIME

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DAS MAN → received meanings and average everydayness; structural, not wickedness.
- FEAR → determinate threat; ANXIETY → familiar significance recedes without one object.
- ANXIETY → discloses being-in-the-world and Dasein's ownmost finite possibility.
- DEATH → ownmost, non-relational, certain and indefinite possibility.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- NOT → suicide, death-seeking, morbid heroism or biological event alone.
- ANTICIPATION → individualises Dasein and exposes the finitude of every possibility.
- RESOLUTENESS → owning thrown possibilities within, not outside, the shared world.
- AUTHENTICITY → formal modification; not moral superiority or social isolation.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- OBJECTION → normatively empty; death-centred and politically vulnerable resoluteness.
- VERDICT → strong ontology of ownership; thin guidance about which possibilities to own.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The They's familiar meanings -> anxiety -> finite ownmost possibility -> anticipation -> resoluteness -> authentic ownership within the shared world.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Heideggerian authenticity is the resolute ownership of finite, thrown possibilities disclosed through anxiety and being-towards-death, not moral superiority, social retreat or fascination with biological dying.

04

STAGE 04 — HEIDEGGER: TEMPORALITY, FUTURE PRIORITY, HISTORICALITY AND LIMIT

TEMPORALITY = MEANING OF CARE · FUTURE / HAVING-BEEN / PRESENT · FINITE ECSTATIC UNITY · CLOCK-TIME IS DERIVATIVE · HISTORICALITY + INCOMPLETE PROJECT

TEMPORALITY → meaning of care; not external clock-time surrounding Dasein.

FUTURE → projection, anticipation and ahead-of-itself; structurally primary. → **HAVING-BEEN → thrownness and the inherited past Dasein still is.** → **PRESENT → involvement, making-present and being alongside entities.**

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- TEMPORALITY → meaning of care; not external clock-time surrounding Dasein.
- FUTURE → projection, anticipation and ahead-of-itself; structurally primary.
- HAVING-BEEN → thrownness and the inherited past Dasein still is.
- PRESENT → involvement, making-present and being alongside entities.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ECSTASES → one finite unity, not compartments arranged on a time-line.
- ANTICIPATION → gathers thrown existence into a whole and links time to authenticity.
- VULGAR TIME → derivative public sequence of measurable nows.
- HISTORICALITY → inherited possibilities projected anew; history is how Dasein exists.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- LIMIT → Division III was not published; Dasein's time does not complete ontology.
- BRIDGE → Sartre grounds open self-making in the for-itself's nothingness.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Care -> future projection + having-been thrownness + present involvement -> finite ecstatic unity -> authentic historicality -> derivative public now-series.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Heidegger's temporality is the finite ecstatic unity of future, having-been and present through which care becomes intelligible, not the external clock in which Dasein happens.

05

STAGE 05 — SARTRE: EXISTENCE, IN-ITSELF, FOR-ITSELF AND NOTHINGNESS

EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE · IN-ITSELF / FOR-ITSELF · NOTHINGNESS / NIHILATION · SARTRE'S HUMAN CLAIM ONLY · SELF AS PROJECT

ARTEFACT → design or essence precedes manufactured existence. → **HUMAN REALITY → no divine blueprint; existence precedes self-made essence.** → **SCOPE → Sartre's formula for human beings; not unchanged Kierkegaard or Heidegger.** → **BEING-IN-ITSELF → full, opaque, self-identical and simply what it is.** → **BEING-FOR-ITSELF → intentional consciousness, lack and non-self-coincidence.**

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ARTEFACT → design or essence precedes manufactured existence.
- HUMAN REALITY → no divine blueprint; existence precedes self-made essence.
- SCOPE → Sartre's formula for human beings; not unchanged Kierkegaard or Heidegger.
- BEING-IN-ITSELF → full, opaque, self-identical and simply what it is.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- BEING-FOR-ITSELF → intentional consciousness, lack and non-self-coincidence.
- NOTHINGNESS / NIHILATION → distance, absence, negation, questions and alternatives.
- SELF-TRANSCENDENCE → consciousness exceeds past, role and present identity.
- PROJECT → provisional self-definition through action; never a completed fixed essence.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- NOT MIND-BODY DUALISM → the contrast is ontological, not two substances.
- BRIDGE → the for-itself is free only within facticity and situation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — No predetermined human design -> human first exists -> consciousness negates the given -> projects possibilities -> self is made without becoming a finished essence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sartre's existence-precedes-essence thesis depends on the for-itself's nothingness: consciousness is never a completed thing but a project that exceeds every identity it has.

06

STAGE 06 — SARTRE: SITUATED FREEDOM, CHOICE, RESPONSIBILITY AND ANGUISH

FACTICITY <-> TRANSCENDENCE · SITUATED FREEDOM · CHOICE -> RESPONSIBILITY · FREEDOM != POWER OR BLAME · ANGUISH / ABANDONMENT

FACTICITY → body, past, social position, situation and events already suffered.

TRANSCENDENCE → surpassing the given through interpretation, projects and action. → **SITUATED FREEDOM → constraints are real; no fact determines its own meaning.** → **FREEDOM != POWER → inability to alter every condition does not erase self-positioning.**

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- FACTICITY → body, past, social position, situation and events already suffered.
- TRANSCENDENCE → surpassing the given through interpretation, projects and action.
- SITUATED FREEDOM → constraints are real; no fact determines its own meaning.
- FREEDOM != POWER → inability to alter every condition does not erase self-positioning.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- CHOICE → even refusal, conformity or delay can position the self and its project.
- RESPONSIBILITY → for meanings and projects; NOT blame for every inflicted event.
- ANGUISH → no nature or rule guarantees what I choose and make of myself.
- ABANDONMENT → no divine value-giver; values cannot be outsourced to God.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DESPAIR → act without assuming history, luck or others will guarantee the outcome.
- LIMIT → early radicalism is qualified by later attention to material social constraints.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Factical situation -> interpretation and projected end -> choice -> responsibility for the project -> anguish because no essence guarantees it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sartrean freedom is radical because no fact interprets itself, yet situated because every project begins from facticity; responsibility concerns the meaning and direction one gives a life, not culpability for every injury imposed upon it.

07

STAGE 07 — SARTRE: IN-ITSELF, FOR-ITSELF, FACTICITY AND BAD FAITH

BAD FAITH: TWO-POLE FLIGHT · WAITER USED CAUTIOUSLY · AUTHENTICITY OWNS BOTH POLES · LOOK / SHAME / OBJECTIFICATION · SOCIAL AND ETHICAL LIMITS

IN-ITSELF → full, opaque and self-identical; simply what it is. → **FOR-ITSELF → intentional, nihilating and non-self-coincident consciousness.** → **FACTICITY → body, past, role and situation; TRANSCENDENCE → projected possibility.** → **BAD FAITH → flight from this tension; not ordinary lying alone.** → **ROLE FIXATION → pretend I am only my facticity and deny transcendence.**

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IN-ITSELF → full, opaque and self-identical; simply what it is.
- FOR-ITSELF → intentional, nihilating and non-self-coincident consciousness.
- FACTICITY → body, past, role and situation; TRANSCENDENCE → projected possibility.
- BAD FAITH → flight from this tension; not ordinary lying alone.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ROLE FIXATION → pretend I am only my facticity and deny transcendence.
- PURE FREEDOM CLAIM → deny facticity and pretend no situation binds.
- WAITER → role-essentialism example; not proof that workers are inauthentic.
- DATE EXAMPLE → evasion of a gesture's meaning and the need to choose.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- AUTHENTICITY → lucid ownership of both poles; less systematic than bad faith.
- LIMIT → self-deception paradox and thin ethics remain unresolved.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — For-itself as non-coincident freedom -> facticity/transcendence tension -> deny one pole -> bad faith -> alienation -> difficult authenticity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Bad faith is not a lie told by one inner agent to another but a unified flight from the facticity-transcendence tension, while authenticity remains the difficult task of owning both without pretending that freedom or situation can be abolished.

08

STAGE 08 — SARTRE: THE LOOK, SHAME, BEING-FOR-OTHERS AND SOCIAL LIMIT

LOOK / SHAME / OBJECTIFICATION · BEING-FOR-OTHERS · CONFLICT AND ALIENATION · NOT EVERY RELATION IS HELL · COLLECTIVE AGENCY QUALIFIES

BEING-FOR-OTHERS → the self as object for another free subject. → **KEYHOLE → absorbed project; footsteps interrupt and reveal that I am seen.** → **SHAME → recognition of myself as the Other sees me; not private embarrassment alone.** → **THE LOOK → another subject is lived through objectification, not merely inferred.** → **OBJECT-FOR-ANOTHER → I acquire an outside and meanings I do not control.**

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- BEING-FOR-OTHERS → the self as object for another free subject.
- KEYHOLE → absorbed project; footsteps interrupt and reveal that I am seen.
- SHAME → recognition of myself as the Other sees me; not private embarrassment alone.
- THE LOOK → another subject is lived through objectification, not merely inferred.
- OBJECT-FOR-ANOTHER → I acquire an outside and meanings I do not control.

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- CONFLICT → possess the Other's freedom or reduce the Other to an object; both fail.
- ALIENATION → freedom is exposed to another freedom's meanings and judgments.
- OBJECTION → love, care, trust and solidarity challenge universal conflict.
- LATER SARTRE → group-in-fusion admits forms of collective, non-isolated agency.
- PYQ 2018 → inauthenticity + bad faith → alienation across Heidegger and Sartre.

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- PYQ 2023 → for-itself, nihilation and non-self-identity ground the bad-faith route.
- ADVANCED → Levinas, care and collective agency qualify conflict; optional, not core.
- VERDICT → decisive account of shame; incomplete theory of reciprocal social life.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Absorbed project -> another's Look -> shame -> being-for-others -> failed recognition -> conflict -> later social qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Look reveals the Other as the subject for whom I am an object, making shame a genuine disclosure of being-for-others while leaving open whether conflict exhausts human relations.

09

STAGE 09 — COMPARISON, EXACT DISTINCTIONS, CRITICISM AND ANSWER SPINE

K / H / S COMPARISON · EIGHT EXACT DISTINCTIONS · CRITICISM -> REPLY -> RESIDUAL · NO FLATTENING · EXAM ANSWER SPINE

KIERKEGAARD → religious inward commitment and the self responsibly before God. → **HEIDEGGER → ontological analysis of finite, thrown being-in-the-world.** → **SARTRE → atheistic freedom, nothingness, responsibility, bad faith and the Look.** → **ANXIETY → possibility / world-collapse / unsupported freedom across the three projects.** → **EXACT PAIRS → fear/anxiety; facticity/determinism; freedom/power.**

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- KIERKEGAARD → religious inward commitment and the self responsibly before God.
- HEIDEGGER → ontological analysis of finite, thrown being-in-the-world.
- SARTRE → atheistic freedom, nothingness, responsibility, bad faith and the Look.
- ANXIETY → possibility / world-collapse / unsupported freedom across the three projects.
- EXACT PAIRS → fear/anxiety; facticity/determinism; freedom/power.

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- EXACT PAIRS → authenticity/nonconformity; subjectivity/arbitrariness.
- EXACT PAIRS → being-in-world/containment; bad faith/lying; death/biological event.
- PYQ 2019/2022 → Dasein, authenticity, temporality and being-in-the-world.
- PYQ 2020/2022/2023/2024 → Kierkegaard: subjectivity, stages and anti-Hegelian self.
- PYQ 2019-2021/2024/2025 → Sartre: freedom, essence and in-itself/for-itself.

EVALUATION / TRAP

- CORE → three projects plus the syllabus triad; sufficient without optional depth.
- ADVANCED → provenance, critics and later revisions sharpen a qualified evaluation.
- CRITIQUE → fideism; empty resoluteness; exaggerated freedom and thin ethics.
- ANSWER SPINE → define → locate project → argue → distinguish → object → reply → limit.
- VERDICT → one problem-field, three irreducible projects; preserve insight and difference.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Common problem -> thinker-specific ground -> mechanism -> consequence -> objection and reply -> exact distinctions -> comparative judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Existentialism's unity lies in making finite existence philosophically primary, while its strength lies in the very disagreements that prevent anxiety, authenticity, freedom and selfhood from collapsing into one slogan.

E

EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT! · ADVANCED SESSION 1 — FOUNDATIONAL MAP - THREE THINKERS · ADVANCED SESSION 2 — KIERKEGAARD - THE SINGLE INDIVIDUAL · ADVANCED SESSION 3 — HEIDEGGER I - DASEIN AND · WORLDHOOD, EQUIPMENT, THE EXISTENTIALIA AND CARE · ADVANCED SESSION 4 — HEIDEGGER II - AUTHENTICITY AND · DAS MAN, FALLING, THE CALL OF CONSCIENCE AND BEING-TOWARD-DEATH · ADVANCED SESSION 5 — HEIDEGGER III - TEMPORALITY (ZEITLICHKEIT)

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — Foundational Map - Three Thinkers, One Shared Conviction, Radical Differences
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Kierkegaard - The Single Individual, Truth Is Subjectivity, the Three Stages, the Leap and Indirect Communication
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Heidegger I - Dasein and Being-in-the-World: Worldhood, Equipment, the Existentialia and Care
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Heidegger II - Authenticity and Inauthenticity: das Man, Falling, the Call of Conscience and Being-toward-Death

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — Heidegger III - Temporality (Zeitlichkeit): the Three Ecstases, Future-Priority, and Primordial versus Vulgar Time
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Existence and Essence - Sartre's Slogan, the Paper-Knife, and Heidegger's Rejection of Humanism
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Sartre I - Radical Freedom, Choice, Responsibility, and the Moods of Anguish, Abandonment and Despair
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Sartre II - Bad Faith, Facticity/Transcendence, and the Pour-soi / En-soi Ontology

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Sartre III - The Look (le regard), Being-for-Others, Shame, and the Conflict of Recognition
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Comparison and Answer Spine - Fear versus Angst across the Three Thinkers, and the Cross-Thinker Synthesis
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- The shared thesis is about priority , not a shared slogan.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels